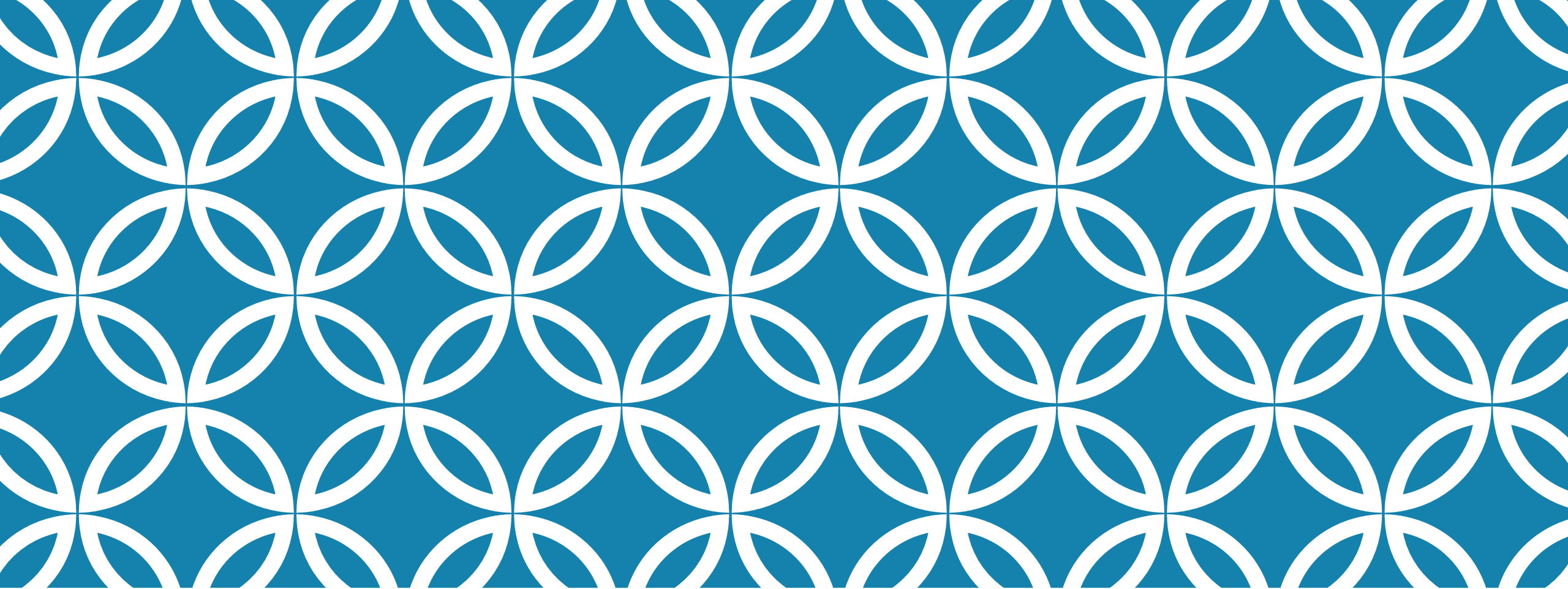
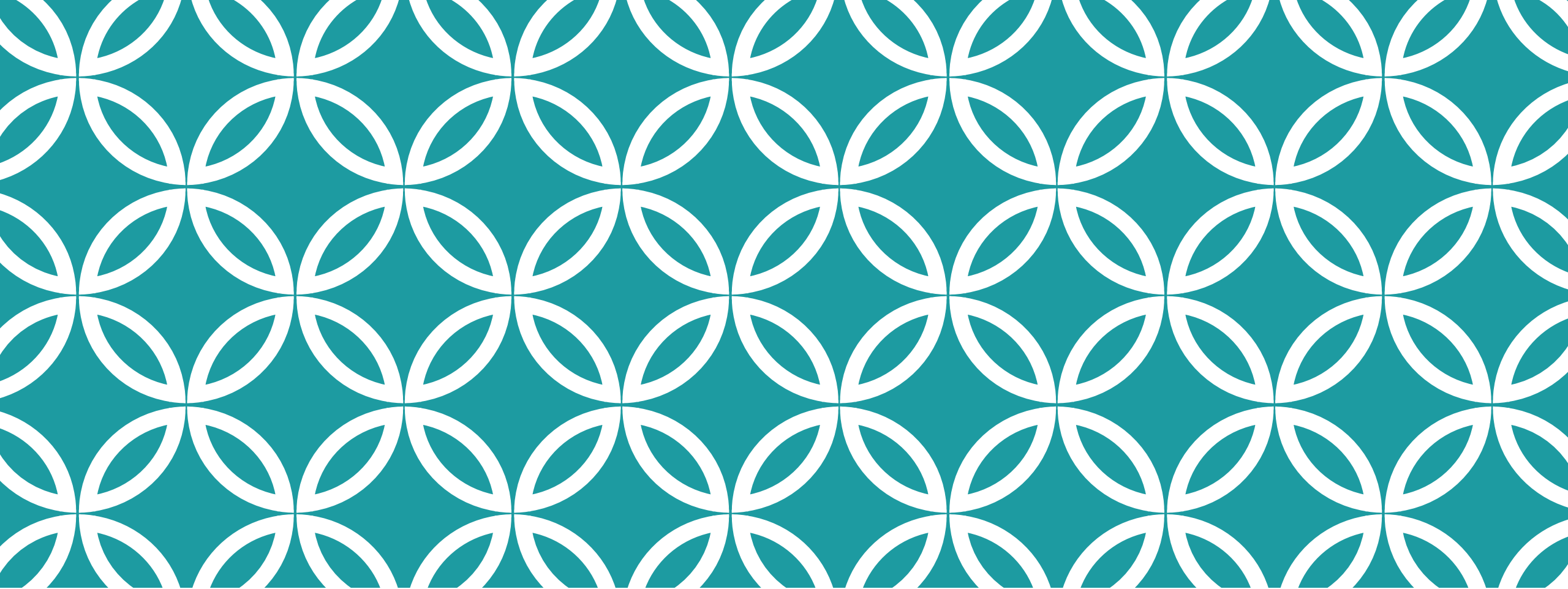




PUBP309: EDUCATION POLICY

Indigenous Education in 19th Century

Shivakumar Jolad
FLAME University



EDUCATION IN MODERN INDIA

A
HISTORY OF EDUCATION
IN INDIA

(During the British Period)

By
SYED NURULLAH
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and
J. P. NAIK, B.A.

With a Foreword
by
Dr. ZAKIR HUSAIN
Vice-Chancellor, Aligarh University

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1961



A STUDENTS' HISTORY
OF
EDUCATION IN INDIA
(1800-1973)

Sixth Revised Edition

J. P. NAIK
SYED NURULLAH

M

MODERN BOOKSTALL,
POONA 1:



Orient BlackSwan

The History of
Education in Modern India
1757-2012

FOURTH EDITION



Suresh Chandra Ghosh

REVISIONS BY PARIMALA RAO

BEYOND MACAULAY

Education in India, 1780–1860

Parimala V. Rao

 Routledge
Taylor & Francis Group
LONDON AND NEW YORK



The Routledge Companion to the History of Education in India, 1780-1947



Parimala V. Rao

ERAS IN INDIAN EDUCATION

Ancient Period/Vedic Period : (1800 BCE-600 BCE)

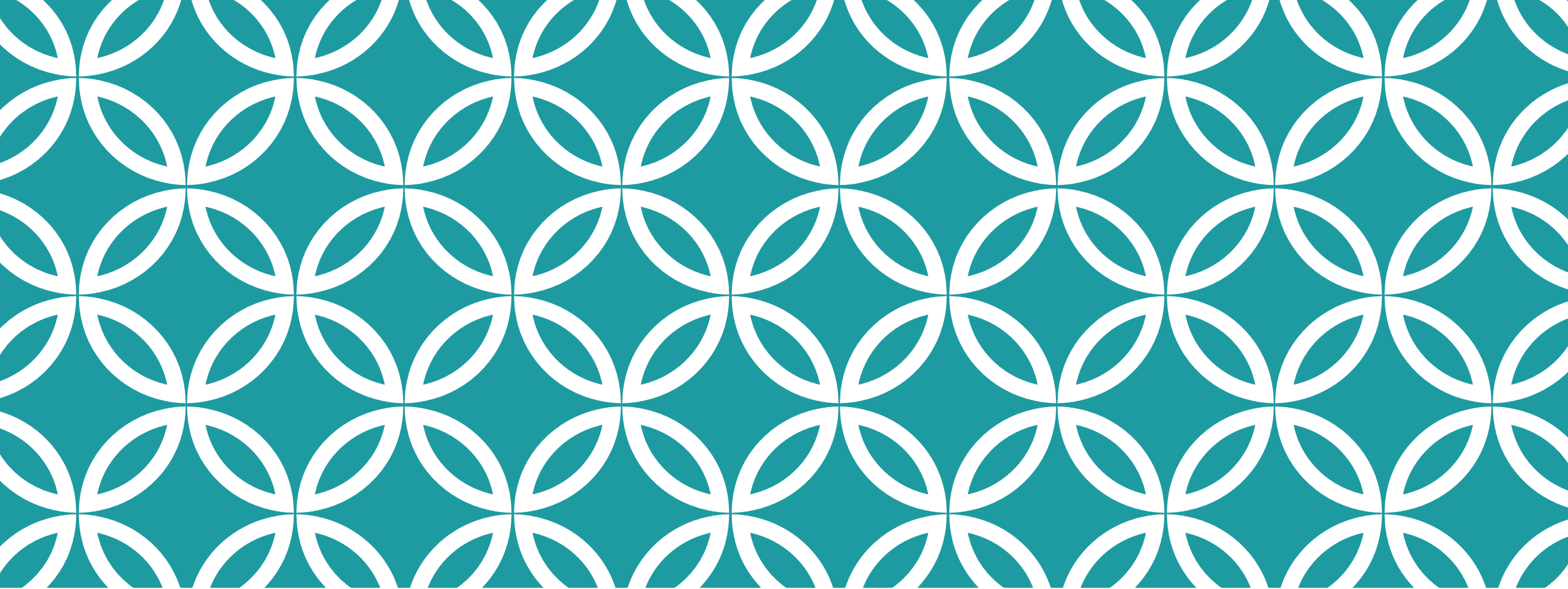
Buddhist Period (600BCE- 800 CE)

Medieval period (800 CE- 1750)

British period (1750 -1947)

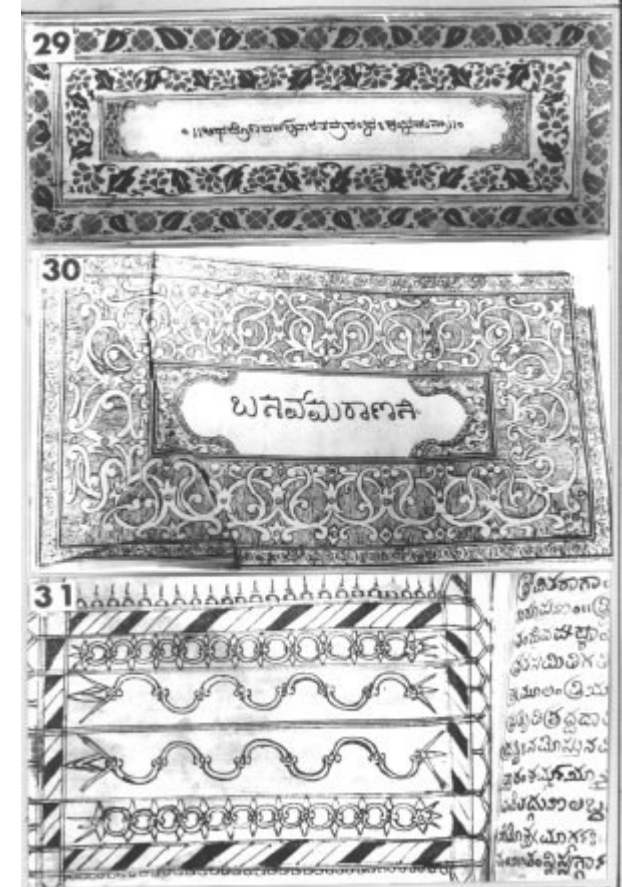
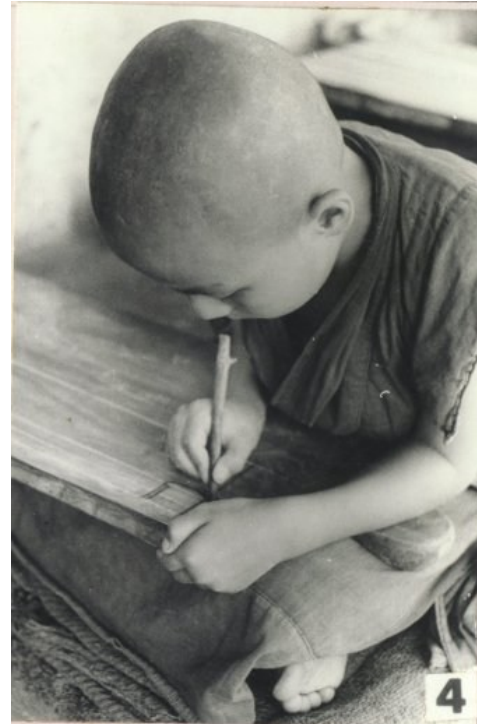
- Indigenous education in 19th Century
- Missionaries and East India Company – Education
- British Education Policy
- School system in colonial India

Post Independence period (1947- Present)



INDIGENOUS EDUCATION SYSTEM IN 19TH CENTURY

INDIGENOUS EDUCATION SYSTEM



PC: Kamat Potpourri : Education in Karnataka through the ages
by Jyotsna Kamat: <http://www.kamat.com/kalranga/edu/index.htm>

SURVEYS ON INDIGENOUS EDUCATION 1820-50



G. W Leitner
1882



Mountstuart Elphinstone
1823-29

T.B. Jervis, Ratnagiri (1820)



William Adam
1835-38



Thomas Munro
1822-26

OF EDUCATION IN INDIA (1800-1973)

Sixth Revised Edition

J. P. NAIK
SYED NURULLAH

Naik and Nurullah

system of education had hardly anything of value in it; that it was better dead than alive; and that the British officers of the Education Department were fully justified in allowing or even helping it to die and in replacing it by the modern system of schools, colleges and universities. It is an essential part of the work of those who undertake to write the history of education in India to find out whether, and if so, how far such a belief is justified. We, therefore, propose to discuss, in this initial chapter, the character and extent of the indigenous system of education as it prevailed in India at the beginning of the nineteenth century (when the British Government may be said to have begun laying the foundation of the modern system of education), its merits and demerits and its potentialities to develop into a national system.

THE BEAUTIFUL TREE

Indigenous Indian Education in the Eighteenth Century

by

Dharampal

Other India Press

Mapusa 403 507, Goa, India

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A. Survey of Indigenous Education in the Madras Presidency 1822-26	89
B. Fra Paolino Da Bartolomeo on Education of Children in India, 1796	256
C. Alexander Walker on Indian Education, Literature, etc., circa, 1820	262
D. Extracts from W. Adam's <i>State of Education in Bengal: 1835-38</i>	270
E. Extracts from G.W. Leitner's <i>History of Education in the Punjab since Annexation and in 1882</i>	343

ELEMENTARY EDUCATION IN VILLAGES

Village **Patshalas** and **Makhtabs**- Taught by Guru's and Maulvi's

Elementary education (Three R's) was mostly a private affair. Villages supported it themselves. No patronage by kings. The need was not felt!

The principal means of their education were non-formal.

The women, as a rule, rarely went to schools

No printed books, only local slates and pencils.. Informal schools- done in house or under trees... Useful for educating peasants, Bania's



Moulvi accepting a student

A Muslim Father Taking Son to Makhtab (school)
Enhanced drawing based on a 16th century illustration

DIVERSE AND THRIVING INDIGENOUS SYSTEM OF EDUCATION

This system was primarily composed of **single-teacher schools** categorized as follows:

Sanskrit Schools (Tols/Pathasalas): Focused on literature, sacred texts, and law, largely for Brahmin boys.

Madrasas: Taught Arabic language, Islamic literature, and law to Muslim boys.

Persian Schools: Taught Persian literature and were often attended by both Hindus and Muslims.

Vernacular Schools: Taught reading, writing, and arithmetic in regional languages (Kannada, Tamil, Bengali, Marathi, etc.) to boys of **all castes and religions**.

DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION

Social Inclusivity: Hindu and Muslim children, as well as those from various castes, mixed for education "without the slightest reluctance". In some districts, such as **South Bihar**, there were no **Brahmin teachers at all in the vernacular schools**.

Financial Support: These schools generally **received no state support** from the British or previous rulers initially. Teachers were maintained through fees paid by parents in cash or kind (grain/gifts) and, occasionally, through land grants or endowments from wealthy individuals.

Curriculum and Pedagogy: Instruction was highly practical. Students typically began by tracing the alphabet on **sandboards**, progressed to writing on **leaves (palm/plantain)** or **wooden boards (takhti/patti)**, and finally used paper. Subjects included arithmetic, agricultural and commercial accounts, and popular poetical works like the *Ramayana* and *Mahabharata*.

MADRAS REPORT- 1822

12.5 million total population. **There is one school (informal) to every 1,000 of the population**

Only 1 in 67 receiving education. No females in schools.

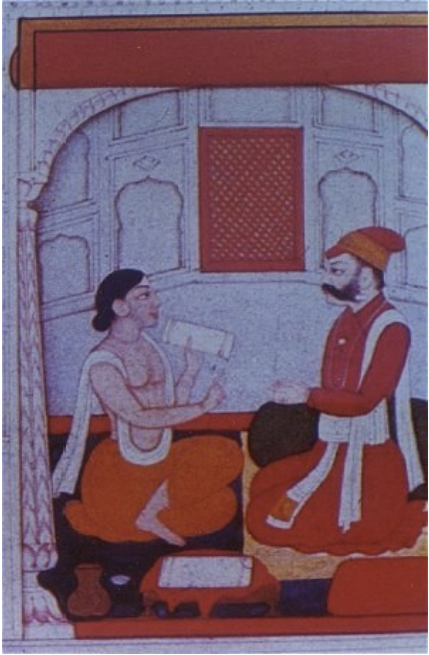
Home schooling was much higher than regular schools.

The state of education here exhibited, low as it is compared with that of our own country, is higher than it was in most European countries at no very distant period.



**Sir Thomas Munro
(1761-1827)**

Source: wiki



Education of the King



Reciting Brahmin



Buddhist Student Practices
Handwriting



Girl engaged in
Self study



Boys at Madrasa



Education of Jain Sanyasins

History of Education in India
An Online Exhibition of Historical Artifacts
by Jyotsna Kamat and K. L. Kamat
<http://www.kamat.com/kalranga/edu/index.htm>

LIMITED ROLE OF STATE (KINGS) IN EDUCATION

Indian society at the end of the eighteenth century was essentially a feudal society

Role of state (kings) in education was limited to supporting few scholars on religious consideration.

Priestly classes who formed a very small minority needed formal institutions for religious instruction and therefore created and maintained them through their own efforts, with such support from the princes



Ancient University Campus
Classrooms are carved in the stone mountain

Jyotsna Kamat and K. L. Kamat

TYPICAL SCHOOLS AND TEACHING METHODS

REPORT OF THE COLLECTOR OF BELLARY (1820'S)

Religious ceremony to initiate education:
Upanayana

Extent of schools depended on parents financial situation

Severe corporal punishments !

Monitor system of education: Senior teaching juniors- widely prevalent.

Rote learning was norm.



shutterstock.com · 608559431



ENQUIRES IN BOMBAY: ELPHINSTONE REPORT

Collected works and interpretation by Sh: R V Parulekar

Most schools were held in temples, private dwellings or sheds, or the houses of the teachers themselves.

Of the teachers, the majority were Brahmins: other castes- Prabhus, Marathas, Bhandarees,

Noted revered status of teachers !

Subjects: 3Rs, multiplication tables.

No education for Harijans and females.

Severe punishment to students were given.



**Mountstuart Elphinstone
(1779 –1859)**

Source: wiki

There are probably as great a proportion of persons in India who can read, write and keep simple accounts as are to be found in European Countries

TEACHERS AND STUDENTS IN RATNAGIRI DISTRICT (BOMBAY PRESIDENCY, C. 1820)

Castes	Teachers	Students
Brahmin	33	567
Dominant castes (Prabhu, Vysya, Maratha, Lingayat)	40	418
Artisanal castes (Kumbhar, Sonar, Mali, Teli, etc.)	9	393
Total Hindu	82	1,378
Muslim	2	65
Jew	2	25
Total	86	1,468

STUDENT COMPOSITION IN THE MADRAS PRESIDENCY (C. 1822–1825)

Districts	No. of Schools	Brahmin	Vysya	Shudra	All Other Castes	Total Hindu Boys	Muslim Boys	Total Students
Arcot N.	630	698	630	4,856	538	6,722	552	7,274
Bellary	533	1,185	981	2,998	1,174	6,338	243	6,581
Coimbatore	763	918	289	6,379	226	7,812	312	8,124
Madura	844	1,186	1,119	7,247	2,977	12,529	1,147	13,676
Tanjore	884	3,180	222	10,661	2,429	16,861	933	17,794
Madras Presidency-Total	11,691	30,479	13,772	75,324	22,794	142,369	10,864	153,233

INDIGENOUS SCHOOLS AND STUDENTS BY PROVINCE (1881–1882)

Provinces	No. of Indigenous Schools	No. of Students	Avg. Students per School
Madras	2,828	54,064	19.11
Bombay	3,924	79,000	20.13
Bengal	3,265	49,238	20.13
NWP and Awadh	6,712	61,634	9.18
Punjab	6,362	86,023	13.52
Central Provinces	83	3,148	37.92
Assam	497	9,233	18.57
Total	17,557	345,482	19.67

BURDEN OF HISTORY: CASTE, GENDER AND LITERACY IN 1901

AN UNCERTAIN GLORY

Table 8.1
Caste, Gender and Literacy in 1901

Region (Province or State)	Literacy Rates, 1901 (%) Brahmin ^a		Literacy Rates, 1901 (%) 'Scheduled Castes' ^b	
	Male	Female	Male	Female
Baroda State	73.0	5.6	1.2	0
Mysore State	68.1	6.4	0.9	0.1
Bombay Province	58.0	5.4	0.7	0
Madras Province	57.8	4.4	1.0	0
United Provinces	55.3	4.6	0.2	0
Central Provinces	36.5	0.9	0.4	0

ACCESS TO SCHOOLS IN RELATION TO POPULATION

Geographic Distribution: Schools were often *concentrated in specific villages or towns*. *In the Ratnagiri district, there were 86 schools for 2,240 villages*. In the North-Western Provinces, 12,987 out of 14,987 villages had no schools at all.

Student-to-Population Ratios: The sources provide specific ratios for different districts:

- **Poona:** One school for every 3,359 boys.
- **Khandesh:** One school for every 4,369 boys.
- **Dharwar:** One school for every 2,452 boys.

Gender Access: Education was almost *entirely restricted to boys*. However, Punjab was a notable exception where women were present as both students and teachers. In Malabar, a few girls from various castes were recorded studying astrology and law.

ENQUIRY IN BENGAL — REPORTS OF MISSIONARY- WILLIAM ADAMS

Published three reports on education. Meticulous recorded the statistics. Considered most reliable among existing records.

First report: carefully prepared digest of all the educational data then available

Second report: Thorough and comprehensive enquiry of one Thana, Nattore, in the district of Rajshahi.

The population of the Thana was 195,296 of which 129,640 were Muslims and 65,656 Hindus. The number of villages was 485.

- Adam found only 27 elementary schools with 262 pupils. Of these 10 were Bengali schools with 167 pupils, 4 were Persian schools with 23 pupils, 11 were Arabic schools

The number of children under domestic instruction was nearly nine times the number of pupils in public schools.

Female education was non-existent

LITERACY ESTIMATES BY ADAMS

Teachers in Hindu Colleges	39
Learned men who were not teachers	88
Students in Colleges	397
Persons who had received an education superior to reading and writing	3,255
Persons who could sign their names or read imperfectly	2,342
TOTAL	6,121

a literacy percentage of **6.1 % to the total male population** and **3.1 % to the whole population including females.**

Adam says these numbers were underestimated.

people got frightened at the enquiry and concealed the exact number of females in the house,

concealed themselves to escape the dreaded inquisition.

his statistics of indigenous education are the most reliable of all the statistics we possess on the subject

POTENTIALITIES OF THE INDIGENOUS SYSTEM OF EDUCATION TO DEVELOP INTO A NATIONAL SYSTEM OF EDUCATION

Potentialities of the Indigenous System of Education to Develop into a National System of Education by Suitable Extension and Improvement: The preceding discussion regarding the character and extent of the indigenous system of education brings us to the final point, whether the system had potentialities which made it capable of being developed into a national system of education by suitable improvement and extension. In our opinion it certainly had these potentialities. We are led to this conclusion by two general considerations. Firstly, we find that, in most countries of the world which are now educationally progressive the national system of education was built up on the foundations of the traditional system—in spite of its admitted and numerous defects. In England, for instance, mass education was spread by gradual expansion and improvement of the defective voluntary schools which already existed. A great authority like Sir Michael Sadler justifies

To whatever extent such institutions may exist, and in whatever condition they may be found, stationary, advancing, or retrograding, they present the only true and sure foundations on which any scheme of general or national education can be established. We may deepen and extend the foundations; we may improve, enlarge and beautify the superstructure; but these

*We have the education of this future state. I say without fear of my figures being challenged successfully, that today India is more illiterate than it was fifty or a hundred years ago, and so is Burma, because **the British administrators, when they came to India, instead of taking hold of things as they were, began to root them out. They scratched the soil and began to look at the root, and left the root like that, and the beautiful tree perished.***

MAHATMA GANDHI , 1931

“English, having been made a medium of Instruction in all branches of learning, has created a permanent bar between highly educated few, and the uneducated many. It has prevented knowledge from percolating to the masses. The excessive importance given to English has cast upon the educated class, a burden which has maimed them mentally for life and made them strangers in their own land”.

(Gandhi, Harijan)

In 1921, the male literacy rate was just 14% (a modest increase from the 6.1% estimate of William Adams in 1835) and female literacy was abysmal at 2.1%, with widespread variations across caste, religion and region.

PARIMALA RAO'S CONTENTION: **INDIGENOUS FOUNDATIONS AND THE "MONITORIAL SYSTEM" MYTH**

Nature of Indigenous Schools (Pre-1857): Indigenous vernacular schools were typically **single-teacher institutions** held in private homes, temples, or sheds. These schools were **socially inclusive**; in regions like Bengal and South India, Brahmin and Shudra students often studied together without resentment.

The Monitorial System (The Madras System): Formulated by **Andrew Bell** in the 1790s, the system utilized older students to teach younger ones to reduce tuition expenses.

The Myth of Indian Roots: Although Bell claimed this was an ancient Hindu practice, sources argue it was a colonial construct used to **discipline the poor in England** and reinforce social hierarchies. Early observers and students of indigenous schools (e.g., Ziegenbalg and Alexander Johnston) found **no evidence** of such a formal system existing in traditional Indian schools.

Colonial Adoption: After 1840, the British government "adopted" thousands of indigenous schools to form the backbone of the primary system to avoid the cost of building new schools.

PARIMALA RAO'S CONTENTION: ORIGINS OF GOVERNMENT PRIMARY EDUCATION (1820–1882)

- **Policy of Incorporation (c. 1840):** The government established **its primary education system by adopting existing indigenous vernacular schools rather than constructing new ones to save costs.**
- **Economic Strategy:** The state rejected higher salary proposals for teachers, opting instead to provide indigenous masters a small stipend of **5 rupees/month** plus a pension for 20 years of service.
- **Standardization Measures:** Masters received one month of training to incorporate modern administrative tasks (registers) and new subjects (geography/maps) into their traditional curriculum.
- **Financial Foundation:** Mass education was funded through a **one percent education cess** (tax) on land revenue, implemented across most provinces by the 1860s.
- **Scale of Adoption:** By 1882, approximately **83% of all government primary schools** (70,000 out of 84,740) were adopted indigenous institutions